

Manipulating agendas

According to Tandoc (2018), disinformation refers to deliberately fabricated information that spreads misleading or biased content about an object or event. This phenomenon poses a growing threat to businesses and democracies alike, as it can manipulate public perception and fuel political polarization, and anti-democratic, and populist movements. The danger of uncontrolled disinformation was evident during various events, such as the anti-vax protests during the COVID pandemic, the US and French presidential elections in 2016 and 2017, respectively, and the Brexit campaign in the United Kingdom in 2016.

Previous research has shown that disinformation during such campaigns was mainly spread by “machine washing,” which involves producing misleading information through AI bots. However, recent advances in AI technology have



given rise to more sophisticated AI agents, which are harder to detect because of their human-like writing style and ability to learn from real interactions. This development has led to a new ethical issue: the potential for setting a fake agenda through AI-generated disinformation.

From an agenda-setting theory perspective, the rise of new/social media has led to multiple stakeholders having direct access to setting the public's agenda regarding business corporations, potentially increasing the risk of mass manipulation and disinformation. With AI agents, corporations and hostile stakeholders can generate believable stories that present a corporation